Arguments in support or opposition of the proposed laws are the opinions of the authors

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE Y

Some will say the City should live within its means. It does. Santee runs a lean, conservative budget, and the San Diego County Taxpayers Association agrees as noted in their endorsement of the measure.

Santee's infrastructure needs have grown while the operating budget has not kept pace. We all drive the same streets. We all see the potholes and the wear on our roads. And we all expect that when we call 911, help arrives fast. These are services residents count on every day.

Measure Y is a one cent local sales tax. By state law it cannot be charged on groceries or prescription medications, so it does not fall on necessities. Visitors who shop here help pay too. A resident advisory committee and independent polling set the priorities for funding:

- Citywide pavement repairs
- New Fire Station at Woodglen Vista to address response times
- Renovation of 55 year old Fire Station 4 (Cottonwood Ave)
- Two new fire engines
- Citywide storm drain replacements
- Restoration of 8 city bridges
- Citywide park improvements

The measure establishes an independent citizen oversight committee to safeguard spending and the tax would sunset after 10 years.

The cost of doing nothing is NOT zero. Every year that major projects are delayed, construction costs increase, infrastructure continues to deteriorate, and future solutions become more expensive.

Measure Y is how Santee gets ahead of this: repair what is failing now, before it becomes a costly emergency.

Vote YES on Measure Y.

JOHN MINTO
Mayor of Santee

BARBARA RYAN
Santee School Board Member (1980-2028)

JOHN HOSSICK
Santee Mobile Home Owners Action Committee

ADAM DANIELS
President, Santee Fire Fighters Association

MARK KERSEY
Executive Director, San Diego County Taxpayers Association

REBUTTAL TO THE ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE Y

Don't be fooled, Santee friends and neighbors!

The City wants to minimize Measure Y by calling it a "1-cent" tax. While technically true, it means 1% of every taxable dollar you spend for the next 10 years! Overnight, gas will cost 5 cents more per gallon, a new car another $500, and everyday shopping and dining will increase. For Santee families, those added costs will total thousands over the life of this tax!

But the bigger question is: Can we trust the City to responsibly manage the money it already receives? An independent July 2026 audit of City travel expenses found significant policy violations, including the mayor, councilmembers, and staff receiving mileage payments while also receiving taxpayer-funded monthly car allowances.

If the City struggles to follow basic financial policies, how can we trust it with millions more of our hard-earned money?

The City also promotes an "independent" oversight committee as a safeguard. But its members are appointed by the very Council proposing this tax. The committee has no authority to stop or reject how the Council spends the money. It can only make recommendations, while the Council retains final say - including spending on things unrelated to the projects they claim this tax would fund. That's hardly independent or accountable.

Santee families deserve competency and accountability at City Hall. Shifting the burden to the residents is not the answer!

Vote NO on Measure Y to keep Santee affordable and ensure city leaders remain accountable!

TONY SHEPHARD
Resident / Businessman

ALLIE SENTERFITT
Teacher

JAMES WILSON
Retired Army / Resident

SHELA TONG
Resident

MICHAEL USREY
Retired / Resident

Arguments in support or opposition of the proposed laws are the opinions of the authors

ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE Y

Protect Santee Families - Vote "NO" on Raising Taxes!

Before City Hall asks for more money, it should prove it has carefully studied this tax, tightened its financial controls, and responsibly managed the money we already provide.

Reasons to vote "NO" on MEASURE "Y"

Higher Costs for Families

A 1% sales tax increase would make Santee families pay more every time they shop, dine out, or buy gas...**for the next 10 years.**

Risk to Local Businesses

Santee would go from one of the lowest sales tax rates to one of the highest in San Diego County, weakening its current competitive advantage. Yet the City has **not conducted a single study of the impact** on local businesses, shoppers, or existing tax revenue.

Accountability Concerns

A recent audit found **inadequate oversight** and **significant policy violations** resulting in improper payments to the Mayor, Council members, and City Staff.

No Guarantee on Spending

The money from this tax would enter the general fund and could be **spent on anything** including city raises, special projects, or continued efforts to force Fanita Ranch upon us.

Raising taxes without a clear plan, sound analysis, or current spending accountability is not leadership...it's an attempt to simply shift the burden onto Santee families.

Please Help Keep Santee Affordable - Vote "NO" on MEASURE "Y"

TONY SHEPHARD
Santee resident

JAMES WILSON
Retired US Army

SHEILA TONG

ALLIE SENTERFITT
Teacher

MICHAEL USREY
Retired

REBUTTAL TO THE ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE Y

Measure Y has been vetted and endorsed by longtime residents and elected leaders, the Santee Mobilehome Owners Action Committee, the Santee Firefighters Association and the San Diego County Taxpayers Association.

Know the facts before voting:

FACT: Measure Y secures vital funding for streets, pothole repairs, sidewalks, storm drains, fire facilities, and parks. Some facilities are decades old and were built before Santee was even a city.

FACT: Measure Y ensures firefighters and paramedics can respond quickly to 911 emergencies.

FACT: Measure Y requires a local citizens' oversight committee to publicly review and verify all spending, and independent audits. This is why the San Diego County Taxpayers Association endorsed Measure Y.

FACT: The City annually hires a certified public accounting firm to conduct independent audits, which have found no irregularities. The City has been recognized nationally for 21 consecutive years for excellence in financial management.

FACT: Measure Y by law, requires that every dollar raised by Measure Y be spent in Santee. No funds can be taken by the State or used elsewhere in San Diego County.

FACT: Essential purchases including groceries, prescription medicines, and diapers are exempt from Measure Y.

Measure Y is about safer streets, reliable infrastructure, and stronger emergency services.

Measure Y is temporary. The needs are not. The longer we take to address these vital infrastructure needs, the more they will cost.

Vote Yes on Y to protect the quality of life that makes Santee a great place to live.

JOHN MINTO
Mayor of Santee

JIM BARTELL
Charter Santee City Councilman (1980-2002)

BARBARA RYAN
Santee School Board Member (1980-2028)

JOHN HOSSICK
Santee Mobile Home Owners Action Committee

ADAM DANIELS
President, Santee Fire Fighters Association